

Extreme Tux Racer

Genre: Racing / Adventure

Game play

I guess, after SuperTux, this would be the most popular game on the Linux platform. Tux Racer is simple and very entertaining to play. Here, you control Tux as it slides on the mountain, to catch as many herrings as possible. Also, you will have to finish the race in time, or you lose. Moreover, the game needs you to jump over glaciers, glide in the waters and also perform 'tricks'.



As with any coin, this one has another side too.

Changing video resolutions screwed up the alignments. The game was also a bit buggy since it got me stuck into the mountains thrice in a row (probably punishing me for racing Tux over everything I possibly could). Moreover, the model of Tux could be made a bit more realistic. It seemed very 'plasticity', in the game.



Download URL: <http://www.extremetuxracer.com/?download>



Pingus

Genre: Puzzle

Disclaimer: This is undoubtedly the best game I have played, in the whole DVD. So, expect my review to be a bit fanboy-ish.

Game play

It has been scientifically proven that breaks at regular intervals increase productivity and there could be no better game (other than Desktop Towers Defence) than Pingus to fit into that bracket. What's more, Pingus is so addictive that it definitely manages to keep you rooted to your seat, scenario after scenario.

This game is basically an adaptation from the hugely

popular Lemmings game, i.e., combining various skill sets to attain a certain goal. Basically, you have a specific number of penguins that have to be saved to accomplish certain missions. Penguins start showing up at a certain point of the map, and you have to carefully guide them until they reach the exit.

Every mission has certain abilities that you can equip the penguins with, in order to pass obstacles that stand in their way. For instance, you may sometimes need to equip your penguins with floaters (little propellers mounted on their head), so that when they reach a gap, they gently land on the ground, and not hit it at great speed and die. You can also make the penguins jump over gaps to reach a specific point, or better, build a bridge over the gap and never have to worry about making sure every penguin jumps over.

The only part about the game that I hated was that it had too few levels (just 8 Halloween maps).



Video

The graphics of Pingus is satisfying but, given that it's a 2D game designed more for thinking than to please the eye, it can be deemed quite good.

The entertaining aspect comes not from superb landscapes or appealing effects, but from the contentment you feel when you finish a mission. So much so, the animation rendered to the penguins when they are enabled with certain abilities are also quite cute. I will always vote for the 'basher' animation.

Download URL: <http://pingus.seul.org/download.html>

